

Figure 5. Mother goddess, likely Lajja Gauri

Wandering a few steps further south along the riverbank brings us to a pillared hall that is a burning ghat or a cremation site. Sculptural clues and relief carvings of goddess Sati indicate that the practice of sati takes place here, at least occasionally, and is likely associated only with the warrior class.[13] From further down the riverbank, we hear the din of dock workers ferrying goods to and from the boats docked along designed piers. Travellers and touts throng the steps of the adjacent harbour, a key transit point for commerce and people passing in and out of the city.

We find a range of secular structures towards the south and east of the citadel, including residences—some with multiple rooms along a common veranda. Dignitaries and expats, such as Saka or Kushan noblemen, inhabit the finest of these homes. Each of these have a central pillared pavilion with stone floors, tiled roofs and walls built of rubble stone or standardized bricks, and finished with lime plaster. Most homes are separated from other homes by a compound wall and feature indoor plumbing—typically a brick drain leading from the house and connecting to a street drain. These drains, some open, others covered, and up to 10–12 inches wide, empty into nearby soak pits or septic tanks. Humbler homes rely more on bamboo and thatch. But even most of these have front and rear verandas and an inner courtyard